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easy — there've been no soft 200s. That's fabulous. And you can feel it everywhere — the stands, the press box, the corporate boxes — this sense that you're watching something special.

*(Smiles)* I wasn't planning to come in today [final day]. But after last night, it felt like it would be a shame to miss it.

**Is Bazball the way forward — or just a necessary tactic to keep Test cricket relevant in the T20 era?**

If teams are capable of playing that way, then yes — it's important for Test cricket to prove it's still worth watching. In an era where white-ball formats dominate and data tells us fans love the instant thrill — balls flying to the boundary, sixes every few minutes — anything that shows how vibrant the long format can be is valid.

But not every team has the talent

or depth to play that way. If you're lower down the pecking order, you've got to find the best way you can to win a Test — even if that means playing more conservatively.

Look at Australia. Sure, they have someone like Travis Head, who fits naturally into a more aggressive mould. But their overall approach has often been pragmatic. That alleged culture clash in the Ashes two years ago — England's ultra-positive style versus Australia's discipline — ended with the pragmatic side winning.

Ultimately, in iconic series like the Ashes or the Border-Gavaskar Trophy, or even the World Test Championship final, it's not about style points — it's about doing what it takes to win.

And part of keeping Test cricket relevant is showing people that drama can unfold in many ways. In that WTC final, the ball dominated

for two days — low scores, not your usual white-ball fare — and then Aiden Markram played a stunning innings to snatch the game. That ebb and flow, those wild momentum shifts, are unique to this format.

I know it's a harder sell to younger fans — and nearly impossible to explain to Americans — but for those who still value Test cricket as the game's highest form, their voice still matters, even if it's a smaller group now.

**With T20 leagues on the rise and bilateral interest fading, what reforms can help safeguard Test cricket without ignoring the game's commercial realities?**

Well, I never quite know the answer to that sort of question. But what's telling is how the conversation has shifted. Two years ago, influential voices were busy